



Not far from the best: The hard-court parallel between Sinner, albeit very early in his career, and Djokovic, the undisputed King of Hard Courts, is noteworthy. AFP

NADAL'S 14-TIME CONQUEST OF ROLAND GARROS MAY BE THE MOST UNBREAKABLE CAREER RECORD OF GREAT CONSEQUENCE

win five straight Wimbledon titles as Borg did, or six total Wimbledon titles non-consecutively? The answer should be easy.)

Second, Djokovic's complete game flourished on every surface: 14 Major titles on hard courts, seven on grass, and three on clay, plus an Olympic gold medal on clay.

However, 'the greatest achievement' is distinctly different from the 'most unbreakable record'. For example, it is hard to conceive of any man surpassing Laver by capturing two calendar-year Grand Slams, and even more inconceivable if you count his 1962 Grand Slam during the Amateur Era (a feat diminished because pro champions Pancho Gonzalez, Ken Rosewall, and Lew Hoad were not eligible).

If we change the question to 'What is the most unbreakable career record of great consequence?'—disqualifying Jimmy Connors' five US Open titles on three different surfaces—my pick is Nadal's unfathomable conquest of Roland Garros 14 times.

The modest Spaniard said he never thought he was "special", but the sports world disagreed. His coronation as The King of Clay is an understatement considering that his closest contender, Bjorn Borg, amassed six French crowns, fewer

than half of Nadal's haul.

Lastly, this sportswriter wondered if Federer, who enjoyed a 24-year pro career, discussed with Ferrero the keys to his long and brilliant career. If he did, rest assured Alcaraz won't share that top-secret information with arch-rival Sinner.

To their credit, the new Big Two have already emulated the initial era of the Fedal rivalry by winning Grand Slams and becoming good friends.

Now that's a feat to celebrate.